2013 Toyota Prius (salvage title)

$3,800 · 190,000 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

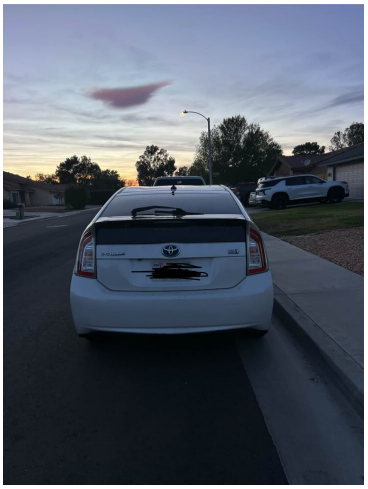
Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

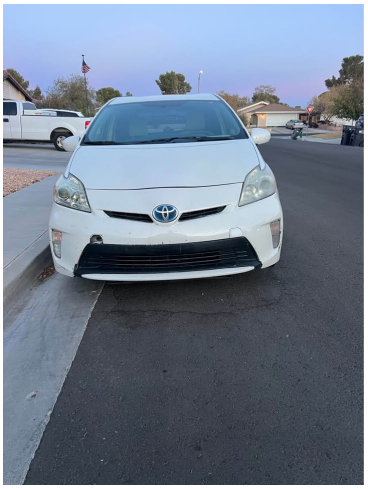
Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1789538772336628/

Report generated October 30, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$4,331	**$330**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 3 recalls · 414 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$3,800.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$351.50
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$24.70
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$32.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$4,331.20
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$4,331.20
Amount financed	$0.00
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$4,481.20

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$0.00
Insurance (estimate, liability)	$70.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 50 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$95.00
Maintenance & repair reserve	$150.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$14.56
Total per month	$329.56

Running costs without the loan: **$330/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$8,436** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

The 3rd-gen Prius is one of the most durable cars made, but this one is a SALVAGE-title car repaired after a right-front collision, at 190k miles. Its real condition depends on the repair quality and the hybrid battery's health - both need the inspection.

NHTSA data for this model year: 3 recalls · 414 owner complaints (40 involving a crash). Most complaints: Service Brakes (242), Electrical System (52), Unknown Or Other (50), Engine (37), Vehicle Speed Control (22), Air Bags (18).

Known issues for this model

• Front-end crash repair quality (frame rail, suspension, alignment)

• Hybrid battery wear at ~190k

• Inverter coolant pump / cooling leaks after a front hit

• EGR system clogging and head-gasket wear at high miles (2010-2015 1.8L)

• Salvage title: limited insurance, lower resale

Check on this car before buying

• Insurance quote with the VIN first

• Toyota of Ridgecrest $185 inspection incl. hybrid battery test

• Frame rail/apron and alignment

• No warning lights; airbag light goes out after startup

• Salvage inspection/registration done; title in seller's name

• Oil and coolant levels

Notes

IN-TOWN CAR (~$3k, for getting to and from work in Ridgecrest; not a DoorDash pick).

*** SALVAGE TITLE *** $3,800, ~190k mi, 2 owners, paid off. Listed 2026-10-28. Seller (Khalid): 'runs great, A/C cools perfectly, can pass smog'; new tires (<6 mo), new 12V battery (<1 yr), brake pads last month.

VIN JTDKN3DU0D5570954 decodes as a REGULAR 3rd-gen 2013 Prius (1.8L liftback, ZVW30, built in Japan) - NOT a Prius c as the ad says. Confirm the dash and door-jamb VIN plates match.

RECALLS: 3 inverter (IPM) recalls on this model; NHTSA VIN check 2026-10-29 = 0 unrepaired recalls.

SALVAGE HISTORY: sold at Copart (San Bernardino, CA) on 2023-12-21, lot 1-76146013 (bid.cars). Auction photos show FRONT-END COLLISION, worst at the RIGHT FRONT corner: bumper torn off on the right, right headlight area crushed, right fender damaged. Doors/roof/rear/windshield/interior look fine; steering-wheel airbag looks undeployed. Similar 2013 Priuses sold at auction for ~$3,000-4,700.

INSPECTION: Toyota of Ridgecrest service, [number in the listing], 321 N China Lake Blvd (Mon-Fri 7:30-5:30) quoted $185. Ask it to cover: hybrid battery health check (Techstream), trouble-code scan incl. hybrid + airbag, right-front frame rail/apron + suspension + alignment, cooling (radiator, A/C condenser, inverter cooler) leaks, written report. Quick DIY check first: Dr. Prius app + Bluetooth OBD2 adapter (~$25).

BEFORE BOOKING: get an insurance quote with the VIN (some insurers won't cover salvage or only liability). Ask Khalid: who repaired the front end (receipts/photos)? frame straightened or replaced? alignment since? salvage (CHP) inspection done and registered in his name? hybrid battery ever replaced/tested? tags current, smog cert? will he drive it to the inspection and split/credit the $185? is $3,800 firm?

If the inspection finds frame damage, a weak hybrid battery or cooling leaks: negotiate down by the repair cost or walk away (fallback: 2008 Accord #43, $2,000, clean title).

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.